

E-mail #4: **"Presentation"**

If you have been following along on the prior sales e-mails you know that it is now time for the **PRESENTATION**.... But just for a quick review... I am assuming that you have qualified the prospect, that you have listened attentively during the Introduction (refer to my last e-mail), and that you now have someone who is curious to learn more....

In preparation for your visit, you should have assembled a three-ring note book with the following material inserted in clear sleeves:

- 1) A sample of each of the following pages from prior Souvenir Programs:
 - a. Full page color ad
 - b. Two page color ad
 - c. Half page color ad
 - d. Half page Star (performer) ad
 - e. Full page black and white ad
 - f. Half page black and white ad
 - g. Quarter page black and white ad
 - h. The "Advertisers' Index" (both alphabetical and categorical) from last year's Souvenir Program, so that you can show a list of the prospect's competitors who advertise with HLSR

Note: ideally, the ad samples and indices (items a - h) should be of the prospect's competitor(s) to show that their competitor(s) has/have the advertising advantage.

- 2) Examples of Donation recognition, including scholarships
- 3) Several Advertising Order Forms (loose in the front so they can be completed easily)
- 4) Several Donation Forms (to be used if the advertiser would rather donate than advertise)
- 5) The FAQ / Fact Card (attached, available for download from your HLSR website and for pick up at the next meeting on Tuesday, September 30)
- 6) Anything else that will help you to help the prospect become an advertiser.

Now that you are thoroughly prepared, you are ready to "sell" an ad.

Here is the big secret: no "sales pitch" is necessary!!!! People actually want to buy... they just need to be helped along.

So what do you say next? While these words may not fit your style, the information is what is important. Please read on...

"The Souvenir Program has been published each year by the Houston Livestock Show and Rodeo since it began in 1932. It is sold at the gates by 4H and FFA members whose

organizations realize thousands of dollars of benefits. With over 25,000 Souvenir Programs sold each year, advertisers like you contribute significantly to the education of nearly 2,000 students today, and to the education of an additional 500 students every year. Not only do the 4H, FFA and nearly 2,000 college-age Texans benefit, but so do you.

This is one of the rare occasions where you can do well by doing good. You can help the kids and potentially help yourself and your business. The Souvenir Program reaches over 25,000 people. With a full page advertisement for only \$1,000, you can reach our audience for less than 4 cents per person. That is less than half the cost of alternative commercial advertisement such as the Chronicle. So helping the kids might just help you as well.

Do you think you would be interested in a full-page color ad?" (show the prospect a full-page or 2-page color ad of their competitor)

Here is another secret to sales success.... Once you have asked a question, stop talking and listen. Do not speak until after the prospect does.

If the prospect says yes, pull out your Advertising Order Form and start filling it out. Don't stop unless or until he/she stops you with a question or an objection.

But what if the prospect says no, or I don't think so, or something other than yes.... What do you do?

My next e-mail will discuss with answering objections.... It is really quite easy...